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SUPERSEDING
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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PLIER, SLIP JOINT (LINE CLAMP)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 One type of slip joint pliers generally used for installing loop type line clamps.

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all types and classes of the commodity indicated by the title of the specification, but are intended to include only those most generally used by the Federal Government.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-C-8603 - Clamps, Tube Support, Loop Type.
MIL-H-15424 - Hand Tools; Packaging of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS SHALL BE AS FOLLOWS:

3.1 Material. Heat treated steel forgings that will produce a tool conforming to this specification.

FSC 5120

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3.2 Design. Pliers automatically lock to hold single or multiple clamps, as specified in MIL-C-8603, in the closed position leaving hands free for installation of retaining nut. Be provided with a multiple adjustment joint capable of 3/4 inch adjustment. Handles are set approximately 45° to the axis of the jaw, with an over-all length of 4-1/2 to 6 inches. Jaw over-all length is 2 to 2-1/2 inches.

3.2.1 Lower Jaw. Slotted to allow clearance over number 10 stud. Contains mechanisms for; retaining number 8 or number 10 clamp bolts and, when actuated, holding the line clamp in a closed position.

3.2.2. Upper Jaw. Slotted to allow sufficient clearance for operation.

3.3 Marking. Mark each plier plainly and permanently with manufacturer's name or known trademark to readily identify the source of manufacture.

3.4 Finish. All surfaces cleaned and free of pits, nodules, burrs, cracks, or other detrimental defects.

3.4.1 Coating. Coated to prevent rust in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice.

3.5 Workmanship. Equal to the highest grade and in accordance with good commercial practices. Rust, fins or any imperfections which may impair the serviceability or durability of the plier are not acceptable.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.2.1 Lot. All pliers submitted for acceptance at one time are considered a lot for purposes of inspection.

4.2.2 Sampling for examination. Select a random sample from each lot for examination in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-105 at inspection level II. The acceptable quality level (AQL) is 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.3 Sampling for acceptance tests. Select a random sample from each lot for acceptance tests in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-105 at inspection level S-3. The AQL is 2.5 percent defective.

4.3 Inspection. Examine each of the sample pliers selected in accordance with 4.2.2 visually to determine compliance with this specification. Reject any plier in the sample containing one or more defects and if the number of defective pliers in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, reject the lot represented by that sample.

4.4 Acceptance tests. Test each sample plier in accordance with 4.5 to verify compliance with this specification. Reject any plier in the sample which does not meet the requirements for any of these tests and if the number of nonconforming pliers exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, reject the lot represented by the sample.

4.5 Tests.

4.5.1 Clamp holding and release test. Using a number 10 bolt, and line clamps listed in MIL-C-8603; clamp and hold one clamp, then insert and hold two additional clamps in succession. After holding the three clamps, install the retaining nut and remove the plier without disturbing the nut or requiring the use of separate mechanical means.

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4.6 Inspection of preparation fo. delivery. Inspection to determine compliance with preparation for delivery requirements is accomplished in accordance with Military Specification MIL-H-15424 for pliers.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Level A or C as specified in the contract or order.

5.1.1 Level A. Clean, preserve and package in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424 for pliers.

5.1.2 Level C. Preserve and package to afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration, and physical damage during shipment to first user. This level may conform to the supplier's commercial practice if it meets the requirements.

5.2 Packing. Level A, B, or C as specified in the contract or order.

5.2.1 Levels A and B. In accordance with levels A and B, respectively, of MIL-H-15424 for pliers.

5.2.2 Level C. Insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Use shipping containers or method of shipment complying with rules or regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking of shipments.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to marking required by the contract or order, mark shipments in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, mark shipments in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options offered herein and include the following data in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Applicable level of packaging and level of packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) Marking, if different (see 5.3).

6.2 Intended use. Slip joint (line clamp) pliers are intended for installing (Loop-Type) line clamps, which utilize a nut and bolt for tightening purposes; for securing wiring, conduit, pipelines, tubing, etc., to each other or to supporting structures.

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